The Sanctuary

Purpose: *To tell the story of redemption and reveal Gods plan to separate sinners from sin. (God is constant / Man is variable)*

Centred on: *Jesus. How God deals with the separation problem.*

Read first - Jer 29:13 & Ps 77:13

First of all, let's look at the problem of sin from a biblical perspective. Which introduces a necessity.

Isaiah 59: 2… **Sin(The Agent)** has caused a **separation(Main element of the problem)** from God and his creatures.

Not only does the Bible provide us with this statement, but the Bible also illustrates and narrates *how* this separation took place.

Genesis 3: 7-10… Here we find out *what happens* when sin enters the equation. Note, with the elite mental status and intellect associated with the recently fallen man, even when they knew that God is omnipresent, they actually tried to **hide** behind a tree! (all men do this now) We must ask why? (First time emotions of – GUILT + SHAME + FEAR)

Sin stupefies the mind. An important truth to note here is that man is the one that is fleeing from God. Unlike popular ideology, God has not separated himself from us; it is a consequence of our fallen nature. Sin in essence, is the desire for independence. **Guilt - Sin is a passion for independence from God (Selfishness)** **Read for later reflection - Gen 3:21…Tunics of Skin**

So how does God feel about this situation? (How?)

Hebrews 1: 9… Jesus **hates** lawlessness/iniquity. This is because it causes separation between him and his creation, the object of his Love. Jesus' heart is full of hatred for sin. An incredibly complex controversy in the heart of every human soul.

God Loves righteousness as much as he hates Sin.

(i) – Kidnapp 10yr old for 18yrs, how feel, God's children kidnapped 6,000yrs – God has bigger prob

Now that we have an understanding of the problem of sin, try and consider the situation presented before the creator.

- (A) The thing God hates the most is inside the thing he loves the most.
- (B) The thing God loves the most is in love with the thing God hates the most.

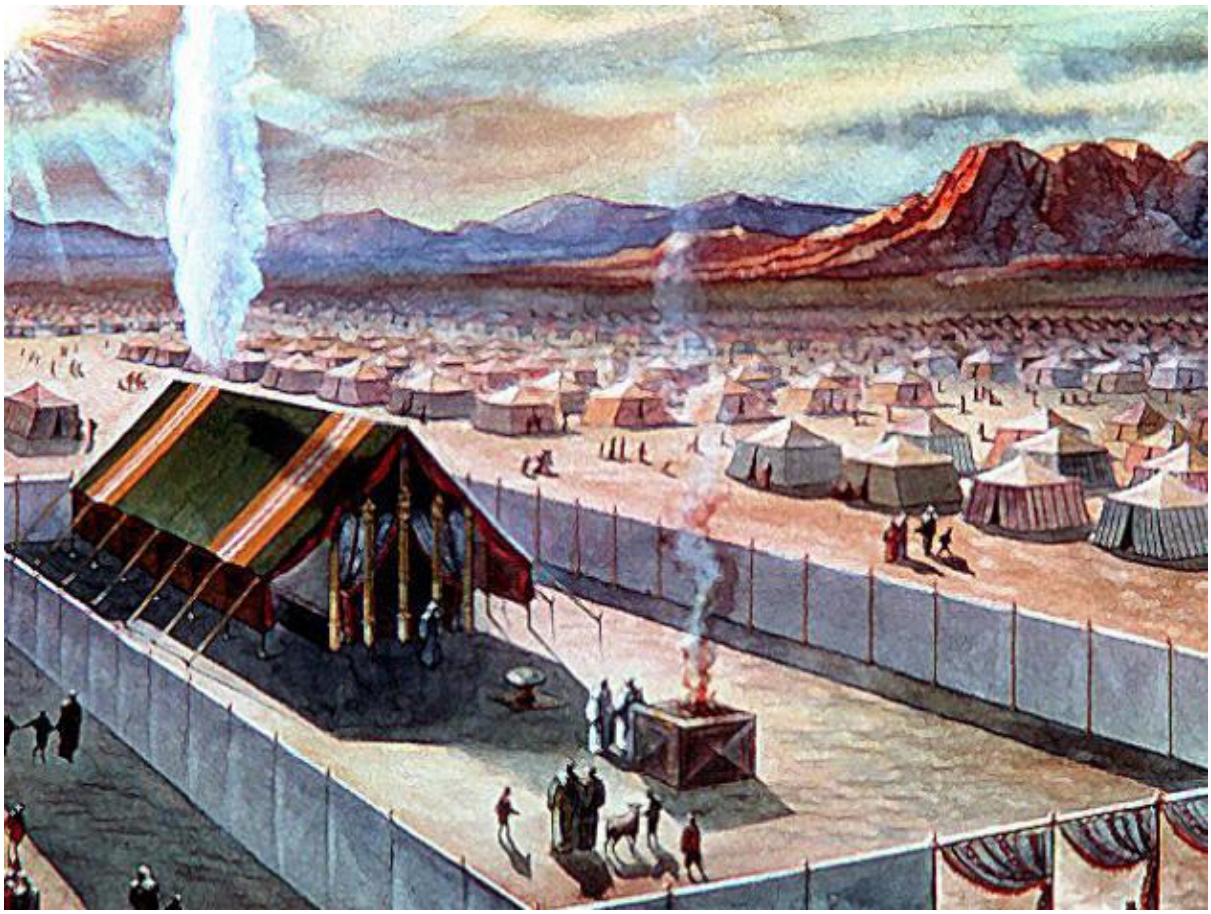
So there lies the question, how does God separate the object of his hatred from the object of his love (sinner from the sin?) The answer is, by a surgical procedure, and this procedure is found within the sanctuary message.

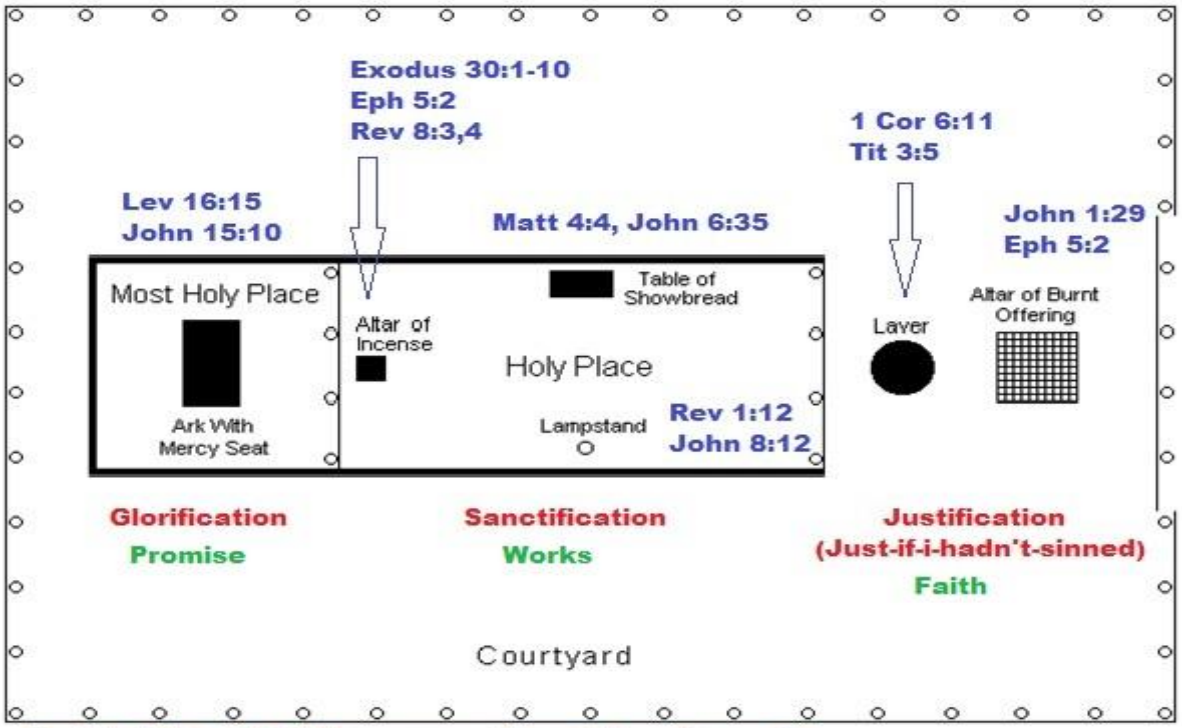
Exodus 25: 8,9… Here God is giving instructions to his people. Question: according to verse 8, what is the purpose of the sanctuary? (John 1:14) – Relationship & Revelation

Answer: so that God may **dwell among** them. Here we find a reversal of the separation problem caused by sin. **– God then gave them instructions how to build it according to the pattern.**

Exodus 25: 22… Again we find the element of proximity.

(Draw Sanctuary)





The Sanctuary





The entire system of the Hebrew sanctuary camp centred on and revolved around what was inside the Ark which was situated in the most Holy place. Why was this so important?

Deuteronomy 10: 4-5…This is **the place where Moses placed the Holy Law of God**, the Ten Commandments, the basis of their covenant agreement.

So we may ask, how does a tent in the middle of the desert with a bunch of weird ceremonies associated to it, have anything to do with fixing the sin problem?

Leviticus 1: 1-5…God is instructing his people to bring an offering of sacrifice to make **atonement** for the repentant sinner. Notice in verse 5, "*he* shall kill the bull." It is imperative to understand that the sinner is the one whom kills the sacrifice. **To remove Shame+Fear+Guilt**

The priest would then carry some of the blood and sprinkle it on the altar, and would then progress to the Holy place where he would sprinkle some more blood before the veil separating the Holy place and the most Holy place. The entire ritual was carried out for the purpose of making "atonement" with God. But why would God prescribe such a gruesome process? Why the shedding of blood? (i) Sinner walking through the camp to the gate of sanctuary, hands on lamb then slit the throat himself for his own sin. (illustrate - Killing an innocent animal)

The Sinner now associates Sin with death/suffering. (Killing the Lamb).When you know what it costs to replace something broken, guilt is more, therefore less attractive. Sin is very Expensive

Is God a blood thirsty tyrant? Why sprinkle blood before the veil? (Rem Law behind it-immutable)

Leviticus 17: 11… Blood represents **life**. Sin requires the life of the sinner. (Rom 6:23)

Hebrews 9: 22… Without something bleeding, there is no forgiveness of sins.

The lesson God was trying to portray is that *sin kills.* Atonement is extremely expensive & this is what God was trying to communicate.

1 John 3: 4… According to scripture, the violation of the law is what sin is. God placed the law within the Ark as a perpetual reminder as to what sin actually is! The Law is thirsty for Blood. The Law of God requires 100% obedience; only blood (life) can pay for sin. Sin = Death.

Now we can transition from OT ceremonies to NT fulfilment

Hebrews 10: 1-4… Here we find Paul alerting to the fact that the Old Testament sacrificial system was a type or shadow of a future event. The repetitive sacrifices made on the altar where designed to remind us of sin and the coming Messiah. We don't understand the grossness of Sin so God shows us using the sanctuary as a model. Sin isn't an action it's a condition. God is trying to interrupt our relationship with sin.

Lets look at the fulfilment of the OT future event. JESUS

Hebrews 10: 10… Jesus is the fulfilment of the sanctuary system. His sacrifice is *once for all*.

1 Peter 1: 19… Jesus had *life* without blemish. A perfect fulfilment of the Law.

John 1: 29… This statement is only possible through the Jewish understanding of the sacrificial system. The Law requires a love of the law giver for this to be possible – Jesus our Substitute

Now lets look at the transaction after the Cross of Calvary

2 Corinthians 5: 17-21… Jesus is the answer to the sin/separation problem. Christ was treated as we deserve, so that we may be treated as he deserves. We pray in Jesus name by faith as the sacrificial lamb – he is the **Substitute** who takes my place and my sin. Justification (Just as if I had never sinned)

Christ was treated as we deserve that we might be treated as he deserves. (EGW - DA 25.2) Gal 2:20

So what has this to do with me now

Hebrews 6: 6… Here Paul is addressing a Christian audience. If these Christians should reject their Saviour and return to their former ways, it would be as if they crucified Him afresh. This is what the **cross means now**. We look back to it, Adam looked forward to it. (James 2:17-24 Faith/works)

Appeal:

Remove Jesus from the Sanctuary and it doesn't make a lick of sense.

The Sacrifices of the OT were like a walk in the park compared to what Jesus went through.

It's the essence of Sin (Separation) that hurts God, not the Cross & nails.

What you do with your life directly affects Gods feelings

Sin brings pain to God, who feels Joy & Happiness and yet also suffered with us

God is close to us and makes himself vulnerable to us

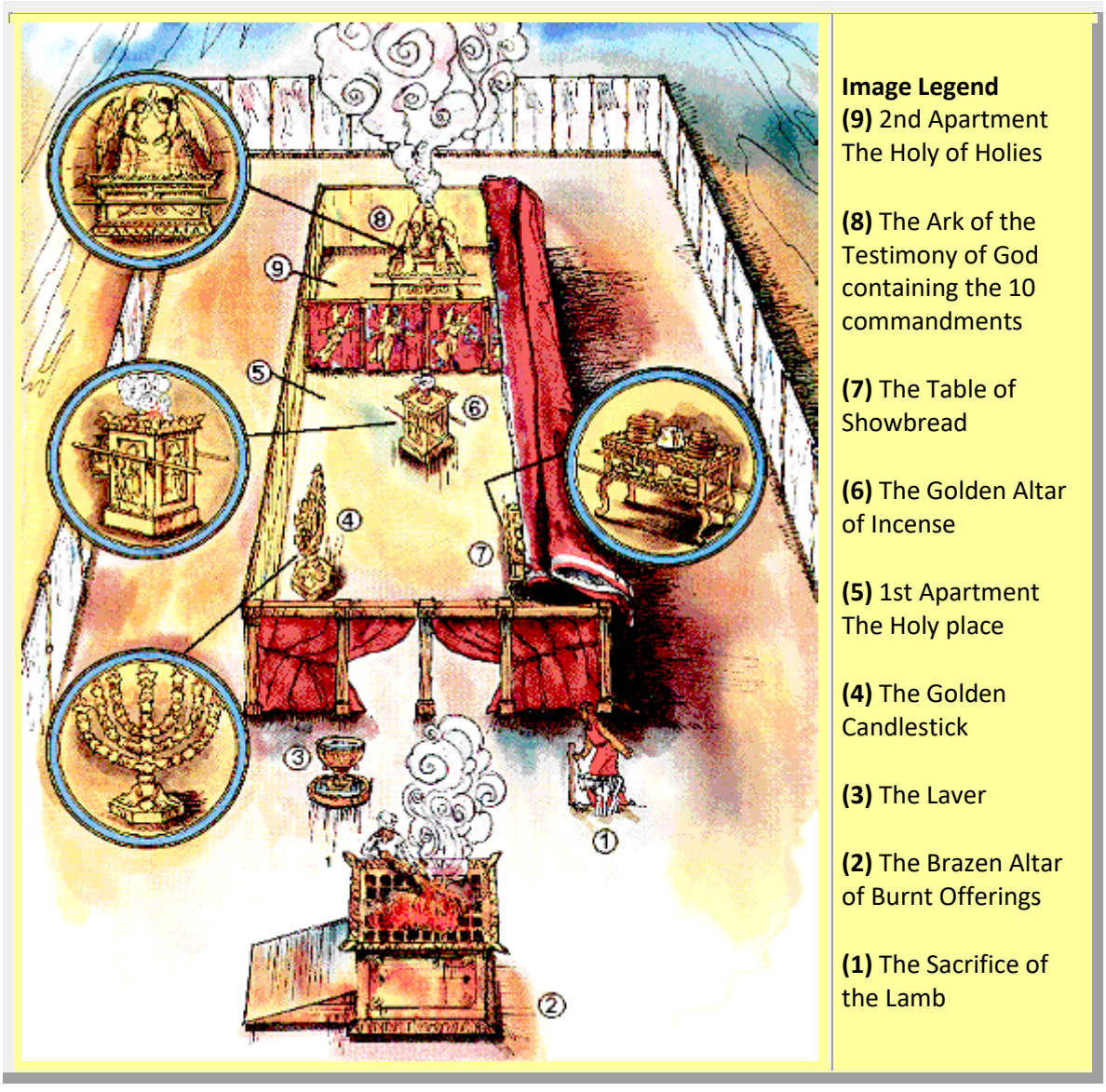
He speaks to us thru his word to put an end to his pain

Are you willing to Surrender to God and let him perform the surgical procedure of separating the object of his Love…YOU from the object of his Hatred.

Furniture within the sanctuary:

To better understand the typological significance of the sanctuary and its contribution to the understanding of Christ's high priestly ministry, the different functions of the sanctuary should be studied in detail.

God's request for a tabernacle among the Israelites came after they left Egypt and made a covenant with God (Ex. 25: 8). This suggests that *redemption precedes access* to the sanctuary because only those who have been redeemed and have entered into a covenant relationship with God can enjoy full communion with Him. The sanctuary is, in a sense, an attempt to restore to the Edenic state of close fellowship with God.



In Old Testament times, God *told* his people that he had a plan to save them. He told them that Jesus would someday die for them. He told them all the facts about redemption. But that was not enough. God also chose to *show* his people what salvation looked like. He chose to let them experience it through their senses so they could see, hear, feel, smell and taste everything he

wanted them to understand. Everything about the sanctuary opened their eyes to some part of what salvation meant.

The sacrificial lamb;

We have already seen in **John 1: 29**, that the lamb was a representation of the coming messiah. Let's take a further look at additional details.

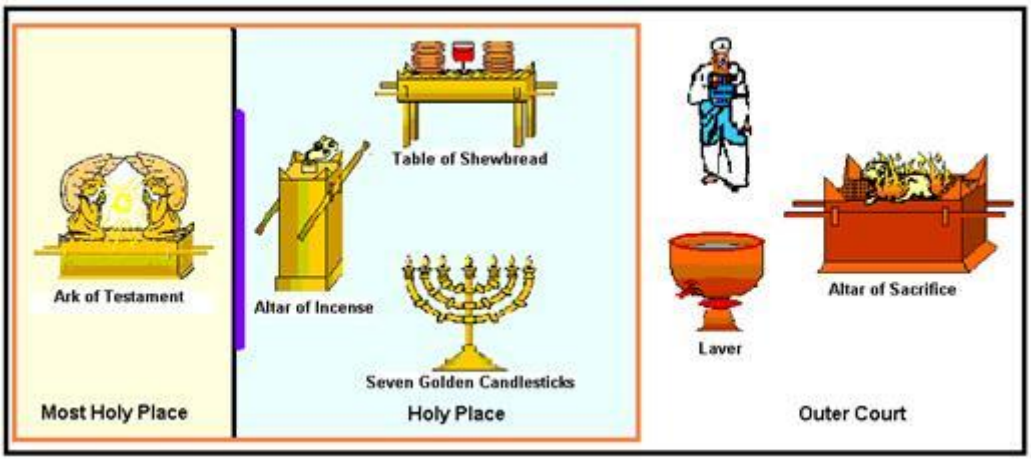
The brazen altar; (Ex 27:1-8, 38:1-7)

Ephesians 5: 2…Over and over again in the Old Testament it speaks of the sacrifices sent up a sweet aroma to God. ***John 1:29, Heb 10:10***

The laver; (Ex 30:18-21,38:8)

1 Corinthians 6: 11…You were *washed*.

Titus 3: 5…Not by works, but by his *washing* of regeneration.



The golden candlesticks; (Ex 25:31-39,37:17-24; Eph 2:10)

John 8: 12…Why does Jesus make these statements that perfectly fit with the imagery of the ancient Hebrew Sanctuary? He is making a point! He is communicating that he is the fulfilment of all this stuff.

Revelation 1: 12…Here we find Jesus walking in the midst of *seven golden lamp stands.* So here in the book of revelation, we see Jesus standing in the Holy Place! The seven lamp stands also represent the seven churches throughout history (Rev 1: 20), furthermore, according to Matthew 5: 14, *you* are the light of the world!

Jesus is the light and his followers are the light. So in the Holy Place of the sanctuary, the Seven Golden Candlesticks represent the ministry of Jesus and the founding of the Christian church. (Mat 5:14)

The Table of Shewbread; (Ex 25:23-30,37:10-16)

John 6: 35…Again Jesus is borrowing imagery from the sanctuary. The bread represents Jesus; he provides sustenance, not only physically but also spiritually.

Matthew 4: 4…Jesus here is correlating bread with the word of God. In other words, we need to consume the word of God in like manner as we need to consume food. This is further elaborated in Revelation 10: 9, where that angle uses the terminology *"take and eat it"* in reference to the word of God. The Word became flesh.

The Altar of Incense;

Exodus 30: 1-10… The altar of incense, placed by the veil, had a horn on each corner. It was used to burn incense twice a day before the Lord. This incense represented the prayers of the saints ascending to God (Psalm 141: 2).

Ephesians 5: 2…According to this verse, Christ's merits are the fragrances that make our prayers acceptable before the Lord.

Revelation 8: 3-4… The picture is that of the angel adding incense to the prayers of the saints as these prayers ascend to the throne of God. The scene portrayed, may be understood as symbolic of the ministration of Christ for His people **(Rom. 8: 34; 1 John 2: 1; Psalm 141:2).**

The Ark of the Covenant (Lev 16:15; John 15:10)

The two tables of stone consisting of the Ten Commandments written by God himself, was placed within the ark. How do we find these two rocks as a representation of Jesus?

Old Testament:

Lev 16:15

Psalm 42: 9…God is likened to Rock

2 Samuel 23: 2-3…God is the rock of Israel.

Deuteronomy 32: 3-4…God is the rock.

Isaiah 26: 4… *"Everlasting strength."* Hebrew translates as literally, "an everlasting rock." Christ is the Rock of Ages to all who learn to place their trust in Him.

New Testament:

Matthew 16: 18…Jesus is saying here that he is the foundation of the church! Only upon him is the church to be built and centred upon.

1 Corinthians 10: 1-4…Christ is the rock.

Jesus was the embodiment of the law. He was completely obedient to the requirements of the law. Some have said, Jesus was the Ten Commandments in sandals. The commandments are a transcript of the character of God.

John 15: 10… Looking back, Jesus could say with perfect confidence, "I have kept my Father's commandments." He did always those things that pleased His Father (John 8: 29). He "did no sin, neither was guile found in his mouth" (1 Peter 2: 22). His sinless life proved that it was possible for men with divine help to keep the commandments

Now can you imagine if we look at the Old Testament sacrificial system and not see Jesus in it anywhere! Let's try to disconnect Jesus with the sanctuary system! None of it would make a lake of sense if we removed Jesus from the picture.

Consider this: You may have heard that people living in OT times were saved by keeping the law, and now in NT times, we are saved by grace. That is incorrect! We were never saved by works but rather by the grace and merits of Christ. From Adam to now, we rely on the Cross of Calvary.

Genesis 3: 15-21…Here we have the first promise. When Adam and Eve were found naked, God clothed them. This was the origin of the sacrificial system. This is where God for the very first time, demonstrated before his creation, exactly how he intended to redeem fallen man.

Coates of skins: Before expelling Adam and Eve from the garden, God provided them with more durable clothing, suitable for the hard labor that lay ahead and as protection against the extremes of heat and cold that followed the fall. Also the skins were a constant reminder of their lost innocence, of death as the wages of sin, and of the promised Lamb of God, who would by His own vicarious death take away the sins of the world. He who had been commissioned protector of the animal creation now unhappily found himself taking the life of one of them. They must die that he might live.

The sacrificial service, though not specifically mentioned here, was instituted at this time. The story of Cain's and Abel's sacrifices related in the next chapter shows that the first sons of Adam and Eve were well acquainted with this ritual. If God had not issued definite regulations concerning sacrifices, His approval of Abel's offering and His disapproval of Cain's would have been arbitrary. That Cain did not accuse God of partiality is evidence that he as well as his brother knew what was required. The universality of animal sacrifices in ancient times points to a common origin of this practice.

Who is Jesus? (OT- nasty God/NT- nice God).

Genesis 15: 1-7…God makes a covenant with Abraham and God identifies himself as simply **"I AM YOUR SHIELD"** and **"I AM THE LORD"** who brought you out of Ur of the Chaldeans.

Exodus 3: 14…Here God appears to Moses and again reveals himself as "**I AM**." We could say that in the bible, the code name for God is "I AM."

John 8: 58…Jesus here knew what impression this statement would make. He knew that the Jews were exceedingly familiar with the story of Abraham and the burning bush. Jesus was pretty much saying, "do you remember that God whom was speaking to your patriarch Moses? Well that was me!

Numbers 21: 4-6…According to this verse, God had sent fiery serpents upon those whom tempted him.

1 Corinthians 10: 8-9…Paul is referring back to the time of Moses as a warning to his disciples. Note his mention of Christ as the one being tempted!

Jesus was the embodiment of the Old Testament. He was in the Old Testament in the form of shadows, types and ceremonies.

Exodus 17: 6…The Old Testament God of Israel says strike the rock and I will provide for my people.

1 Corinthians 10: 4…Paul is linking the interactions of God with his people in the Old Testament and showing us that this was the person of Jesus.

Sadly, to this day the Jewish nation has not recognised their foretold Messiah. Even in Paul's day he was experiencing the difficulty of the Jewish mind in gaining understanding of the scriptures. Paul notes that Christ was their stumbling block.

Luke 24: 27…Jesus himself declares he is the central theme of the Old Testament.

2 Corinthians 3: 14…Paul had been commissioned a minister of the new covenant, but his ministry for the Jews of his day was no more effective than that of Moses had been in his time. This was because the same "veil" was still upon their hearts and minds.

Three stages of salvation:

- Justification – Penalty – first compartment.
- Sanctification – Power – second compartment.
- Glorification – Presence – third compartment.

Apologetics: Once saved always saved!

John 10:27-28; 2 Peter 2:20-22; 1 Cor 9:27 - Satan was once saved